



YOU SAID IT

Praise for information security-related articles!



I am an information security officer working in Delhi. I liked the March 2011 edition of *LINUX For You*, which included articles on the issue of information leakage and related threats (*Securing Apache and Digital Forensics With Backtrack*). I avidly follow the security-related articles in the magazine. These have revealed the hitherto unknown techniques by which data accidentally leaks in websites. The article on session attacks in the last issue was also good. The layout of the magazine is remarkable, too.

—**Sachin Karmarkar**,
sachinkarmarkar9@gmail.com

ED: Thanks a lot for the pat on the back. Messages like these certainly motivate us to try and do even better.

We wanted to check whether you too use open source tools to manage security related issues at your firm. If so, would you be interested in sharing your experience with our readers? We are sure they will benefit from your first hand account of how you address security-related issues. You could let us know if this interests you, after which, someone from our editorial team will approach you to take things forward in this regard.

A few Debian-related issues

I read Boudhayan Gupta's review of Debian 6.0 Squeeze in the March issue of LFY. It was a good read.

I am a staunch Debian fan and use vendor-supplied DVD-sets. Do allow me to make two remarks.

- (1) There was a point-release of Lenny in January 2011. Squeeze was released just a month later. Apparently, the Debian team rushed in with the new version. The 'System -> Administration -> Software Sources' function is *broken*.
- Debian's website has been changing the relevant details day in and day out. They seem to have finally made up their minds now. The following lines in `/etc/apt/sources.list` should be 'final':
- # Let the 'cdrom' lines be as created by the installer.
- deb <http://http.us.debian.org/debian/squeeze-updates> main contrib
- deb <http://http.us.debian.org/debian/squeeze-proposed-updates> main contrib
- deb <http://http.us.debian.org/debian/squeeze> main contrib non-free
- (2) Most people, including me, would expect installs to work out-of-the-box. Hence our frustration when we use the 'latest' hardware.
- However, Debian seems to be moving in the direction where pressure will be on the hardware vendors; so there will not be a need for developers to reverse-engineer. There may also be a security aspect to the issue, for instance, 'tainted' kernel modules. My nVidia hardware was non-free and 'tainted' a year back, but not any longer.
- The argument that works for software development is likely to work for hardware as well: the more 'open' a vendor's hardware specs, the better chances there are of it getting accepted by the community.

—**Niraj M. Upadhyay**,

niraj.m.upadhyay@gmail.com

ED: We are glad that you like the Debian 6.0 review published in the March edition of LFY. Thanks a lot for finding time to share your observations on the subject. We forwarded your note to the author for his comments. Here is his reply:

Boudhayan Gupta: "I didn't notice that the Software Sources have been ported over from Ubuntu, and hence didn't check it out. I did most of my testing a week before the release, using the FreeBSD releases, and GNOME was horribly broken (even System Monitor wasn't working). I took it for granted that with their focus on stability, the Linux release would be flawless. That trust was just broken after reading your report. So a big thanks for the heads-up :-)

W.r.t. your report on your nVidia hardware, I trust Nouveau is taking care of things then? You might try using the Liquorix kernels at <http://liquorix.net/> (use the Sid repo). That will give you the latest kernels with lots of performance patches, but the biggest upside would be the updates to the DRM, KMS and Nouveau stacks, which I believe you will really appreciate. I haven't had any stability issues with them (I'm on Ubuntu Maverick)."

Praise for the innovative 'wheel' for a child suffering from cerebral palsy



This note is with reference to the article 'Technology To Aid The Disabled' in LFY and linuxforu.com. First of all, hats off to you for doing an article that brought out an innovation like the 'Arpit's Wheel', a communication system designed and developed by Arun Mehta to